

NSON#168 – RECRUIT PORTION

*****Dear Ron, If you find any problems or have comments/suggestions, please flag them and let us know. Please don't alter any wording. Thank you!*****

NSON#

California DP T1 Questionnaire

Hello, my name is [fill NAME]. I'm calling from the [fill in]. We're conducting a survey for public broadcasting in California of what people in California think about California's future. Your telephone number was selected at random.

Is this a private residence?

May I speak with the person 18 years or older in your household who most recently had a birthday? Is it you or someone else?

If R IS the person over 18 with the most recent birthday, skip to B. If R is NOT the person over 18 with the most recent birthday, please continue:

Could I speak with him/her?

If he or she is available, restart at A. If not available, please continue.

I would like to call back to speak with him/her, when do you think I could reach him/her?

- A. Hello, my name is [fill NAME]. I'm calling from the [fill in]. We're conducting a survey of what people in California think about California's future. Your telephone number was selected at random.
- B. It's very important to us to get a picture of what *all* people in California think, so we hope you can spare a few minutes of your time, even if these are issues you haven't thought much about.

IF R agrees to participate:

Great! We're very interested in knowing what you think. If we get to a question where you don't have an opinion, just say so. All your answers will be kept completely confidential. If you have any questions regarding this study, you can contact [fill].

Again this is a survey about what the people of California think about California's future.

1. To begin with, all in all, on a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is "extremely ~~well~~poorly", 10 is "extremely ~~poorly~~well," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how well or poorly would you say the system of democracy in California works these days? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

Policy items

Now here are some proposals we would like your opinions on. Not everyone has thought much about these. But we do need to ask about them. If we come to one you haven't thought about, just say so, and we'll move on to the next one.

“()” Will not be read during survey.

On another 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is "extremely undesirable", 10 is "extremely desirable," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how desirable or undesirable would you say are each of the following? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

2. (A2) Increasing the number of legislative districts so that each legislator represents fewer people~~contains a smaller population~~
3. (A3) Making the State Legislature a single house, instead of its current Senate and Assembly~~S to only have one House~~
4. (A12) Increasing Assembly terms from 2 years to 4, and Senate terms from 4 years to 6~~the length of State Legislative terms~~
5. (B2) Allowing initiative ~~the~~ proponents to amend an initiative following public input
6. (B3) Allowing initiative ~~the~~ proponents to withdraw an initiative it even after it qualifies for the ballot
7. (B4) Allowing the Legislature to enact into law an initiative that has already qualified for the ballot so it doesn't need to be included on the ballot~~Allowing the Legislature to enact an initiative that has already qualified for the ballot into law instead of putting it before voters~~
8. (B5) Putting all initiative dealing with the same subject next to other one ~~another~~ on the ballot
9. (B11) Allowing signatures for initiatives to be gathered electronically
10. (B13) Requiring that initiatives include say how they will be paid for if they would cost taxpayers more than \$25 million to implement a way of paying for anything involving major costs~~that initiatives include say how they will be paid for if they would cost taxpayers more than \$25 million to implement a way of paying for anything involving major costs~~
11. (B14) Prohibiting initiatives that require the State to spend a substantial portion of its budget ~~certain percentage of its money~~ for a specific purpose
12. (N/A) Requiring election campaign contributions to be disclosed more quickly ~~frequently~~

13. (N/A) Allowing voters to rank their top three candidates, so that the winner can be ~~chosen~~ decided in a single election without a second election
14. (N/A) Permitting petitions for ballot initiatives to be distributed electronically, then printed and signed
15. Reducing the number of bills a legislator can introduce during a two-year session
16. Reducing the length of the state legislative session and making the job of State Legislator a part-time position ~~Making the job of State Legislator a part-time position~~
17. (N/A) Appointing all California judges for lifetime terms, subject only to recall election
18. (C1) ~~Expanding~~ Applying the sales tax ~~base~~ to include services ~~as well as in addition to~~ goods
19. (C2) Flattening the state income tax rates, so that everyone pays closer to the same rate (while continuing to exempt low income individuals)
- ~~20.~~ (C5) Taxing non-residential property at a higher rate than residential property
- 21.
22. (C11) Increasing the ~~v~~Vehicle ~~l~~icense ~~f~~ee from 0.65% to 2% and distribute that additional revenue locally for local purposes
23. (C14) Requiring that changes in commercial ownership trigger tax reassessments on the same way they do for residential property ~~Eliminating the existing protections of commercial properties from reassessment~~
24. (C15) Requiring the same 55 percent majority for all local tax proposalss
25. (D1) Assign ~~sole~~ responsibility for service delivery to the level of government that is best suited to carry it out
26. (D2) Giving control of the ~~money~~ funding for a service to the level of government that is responsible for delivering it
27. (D3) Making it easier for local governments to ~~impose~~ levy taxes for services they ~~provide~~ are responsible for providing
28. (D5) Allow local governments to raise ~~local~~ taxes for local ~~purposes~~ services in exchange for ~~producing~~ requiring greater ~~coordination of local services to improve results and~~ greater accountability for program performance

29. Establishing a process to consolidate similar services provided by different parts of local governments and special districts
30. On a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is "not at all", 10 is "as much as could reasonably be expected," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much or little would you say the California State Legislature is able to get things done? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
31. On another 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is "not at all", 10 is "completely", and 5 is exactly in the middle, to what extent is the ability of the State Legislature to get things done affected by hostility tensions between political parties? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
32. And, on a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is completely at the local State level, 10 is completely at the State local level, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much decision-making authority should there be at the local level versus the State level? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
33. And, on the same scale, how much taxation power should there be at the local versus State level? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
34. On another 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is "completely by voters in referendum", 10 is "completely by the State Legislature", and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much of the State's major decisions should be made by voters in referendums versus by the State Legislature? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

Now, how strongly would you agree or disagree with the following statements?

35. People with views very different from mine often have good reasons for their views even when they are wrong. Would you strongly agree, somewhat agree, neither agree nor disagree, somewhat disagree, or strongly disagree?
36. Public officials care a lot about what people like me think. Would you strongly agree, somewhat agree, neither agree nor disagree, somewhat disagree, or strongly disagree?
37. Most public policy issues are so complicated that a person like me can't really understand what's going on. Would you strongly agree, somewhat agree, neither agree nor disagree, somewhat disagree, or strongly disagree?

Knowledge

Now we come to some factual questions to which not everyone may know the right answers. If we come to one to which you don't know the answer, don't worry about it. Just say so and we'll move on to the next one.

38. Which political party holds the majority in the California State Senate, or couldn't you say about that? **(If yes, without naming party, or other)** Which party do you have in mind? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
39. How about the California State Assembly? Do you know which political party holds the majority there, or couldn't you say about that? **(If yes, without naming party, or other)** Which party do you have in mind? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
40. How large a majority of the State Legislature is needed to approve a proposed constitutional amendment?
- a. a simple majority of both houses
 - b. a simple majority of the Assembly and two-thirds of Senate
 - c. two-thirds of both houses
 - d. three-fourths of both houses
- Or couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
41. How large a majority of the State Legislature is needed to ~~pass bills containing tax~~ increase taxes?
- a. a simple majority of both houses
 - b. a simple majority of the Assembly and two-thirds of Senate
 - c. two-thirds of both houses
 - d. three-fourths of both houses
- Or couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
42. ~~Petitions proposing constitutional amendments~~Ballot measures can be signed by...
- a. anyone over 18 years of age
 - b. any citizen over 18 years of age
 - c. only registered voters
 - d. only registered voters who voted in last election
- Or couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
43. What is the maximum increase in assessed property value when property changes ownership?
- a. 1%
 - b. 3%
 - c. 5%
 - d. 7%
- Or couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

44. The majority of revenue for the State's General Fund comes from which of the following?
- a. Personal Income Tax
 - b. Retail sales and use tax
 - c. Corporation Tax
 - d. Local Income Tax
- Or couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
45. The largest single share of the State's General Fund goes to which of the following?
- a. Higher Education
 - b. K through 12 education
 - c. Health and Human Services
 - d. State Pensions
- Or couldn't you say about that?
IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

Background

Finally, a few questions about you:

46. Generally speaking, how interested would you say you are in politics and public affairs in the U.S., very interested, somewhat interested, not very interested, or not at all interested?
47. Generally speaking, how interested would you say you are in politics and public affairs in California, very interested, somewhat interested, not very interested, or not at all interested?
48. When you think of your economic situation today, do you think you are much better off than most, somewhat better off, about the same as most, somewhat worse off, or much worse off than most? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.
49. On average, on how many of the past 7 days would you say you watched the news on TV? If you didn't watch news on TV at all, just say 0.
50. On average, on how many of the past 7 days did you read a daily newspaper? If you didn't read a newspaper, just say 0.
51. On average, on how many of the past 7 days did you read the news on the internet? If you didn't read news on the Internet, just say 0.
52. On average, on how many of the past 7 days did you talk with people about politics and public affairs? If you didn't talk with people about politics and public affairs, just say 0.

Next, we'd like to get your feelings toward some of California political parties, offices, and institutions. Using what is sometimes called a "feeling thermometer." Ratings between 50 degrees and 100 degrees mean that you feel favorable and warm toward a party or person or institution. Ratings between 0 degrees and 50 degrees mean that you don't feel favorable, that you don't care too much for that person. You would rate the person at the 50 degree mark if you don't feel particularly warm or cold. If you don't know the party, person, or institution well enough to rate, just say "can't say."

Let's start with the...

53. Democratic Party. How would you rate the Democratic Party from 0 to 100 degrees?

54. How about the Republican Party?

55. The Governor of California?

56. The State Legislature?

57. The State Assembly?

58. And, the State Senate?

59. Which of the following best describes the highest level of education you have completed? [READ]

- 01 Less than high school
- 02 High school
- 03 Some university / college
- 04 University / college graduate
- 05 Some graduate work
- 06 Graduate degree

60. Other (specify: _____)

61. VOLUNTEERED

62. Refused/No answer

63. In what year were you born? _____

64. And what is your current employment status? Are you currently ... :

READ RESPONSES IN ORDER—CODE ONE ONLY

- 1 Employed full-time
- 2 Employed part-time
- 3 Not employed, but actively looking for work; or
- 4 Student
- 5 Not actively looking for work

6 Refused

65. (If employed) Which of the following best describes your employment?

Self employed

Business fewer than 25 employees

Business with 25 or more employees

Government

Other

(If Other) What is that?

66. How often would you say you attend religious services, every week, almost every week, once or twice a month, a few times a year, or never?

67. Are you currently married and living with your spouse? IF YES, SKIP Next Q.

68. **(If no)** Are you living with a partner?

69. How many children do you have under 18 living at home? If you don't have any, just say 0.

70. Which of the following broad income categories best describes your total household income before taxes in 2010? Would it be ... : **READ RESPONSES IN ORDER—
CODE ONE ONLY**

- 1 Less than \$25,000
- 2 Between \$25,000 and \$50,000
- 3 Between \$50,000 and \$75,000
- 4 Between \$75,000 and \$100,000, or
- 5 Between \$100,000 and \$125,000
- 6 Between \$125,000 and \$150,000
- 7 More than \$150,000
- 8 Refused/No answer
- 9 Don't know

71. Which of the following racial or ethnic group would you say best describes you, White, Black, Native American, Asian/Pacific Islander, Hispanic/Latino or Other? **(If Other)** And, what is that?

72. Some people consider themselves extremely liberal. Suppose these people are at one end of a 0-to-10 scale, at point 0. Other people consider themselves extremely conservative. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 10. People who are exactly in the middle are at point 5, and of course other people have opinions at other points between 0 and 10. Where would you place your views on

this scale, or haven't you thought much about this? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

73. And generally speaking, would say that you usually think of yourself as a Democrat, a Republican, an independent, or what? IF N/A, REFUSED, then 98; IF NO OPINION, then 99.

74. Gender [by observation]

1 Male

2 Female

That was the last question. Now I have a special invitation for you from MacNeil/Lehrer Productions who do the PBS Newshour.

Academic centers at Stanford and Pepperdine Universities along with California Forward, the New America Foundation and other non-partisan and non-profit groups are joining together to hold a Deliberative Poll to listen to the opinions of citizens from all over the state.

The event is called **What's Next California** and will be held over the weekend of June 24th to 26th. As a participant you will have a chance to discuss California's present and future and question policy experts and policy makers. This is a unique way for you and others citizens who are scientifically selected to join the conversation about issues that might be included in future statewide ballot initiatives. The weekend will be moderated by Judy Woodruff of the PBS Newshour and videotaped for a documentary to be broadcast on PBS stations in California and elsewhere

We can offer you a payment of \$300 for the weekend as a token of our appreciation for your time. Travel expenses, meals and lodging will be provided. Participants will stay at either the Marriott South Bay Hotel in Torrance or the Residence Inn You would need to arrive by 5 pm for opening dinner on Friday June 24th and would be free to leave by 2 p.m. on Sunday the 26th. What's Next California is carefully balanced, with all points of view represented and considered. We expect there to be a significant television, newspaper and online coverage.

It's very important to us to get a picture of what *all* people in California would think about these issues when they've had the chance of thinking, learning, and talking about them. Participants in past Deliberative Polls have found them extremely interesting and enjoyable. We hope that you will be able to take part in this exciting and important event.

We understand of course if you need some time to think about this opportunity, but I wonder if you could tell me if you would ...

Definitely be interested in attending this event

Possibly be interested in attending

Or definitely not be interested in attending.

IF DEFINITELY YES,

That's great!!! We're delighted to have you. We'll be back in touch to provide you with all the practical information you'll need. If you have any questions, you're most welcome to call [fill] at the [fill] (number) or [fill] at the [fill] (number). Could we get your address to mail you some materials for the event? Do you have an e-mail address?

IF POSSIBLY,

That's great!!! We're delighted you'll consider it. We'll be back in touch to provide you with all the practical information you'll need and see if you have any questions we can answer. We very much hope you'll attend. Do you have an address where we could send you some materials about the event? Do you have an e-mail address? In the meantime, if you have any questions, please feel free to call [fill] at the [fill] (number) or [fill] at the [fill] (number).

IF NO,

Oh, that's too bad! I want to thank you for your time in responding to this interview. If you change your mind about participating in the weekend event on June 24-26 or if you have any questions about it, please feel free to call [fill] at the [fill] (number) or [fill] at the [fill] (number).